ACTIVITY 014

Prepare on the Gesture

Breathing & Airflow Control

4 minutes / Director and a short sung response.

Link an easy preparatory breath to the director's upbeat.



- Watch the preparation
- Breathe without holding
- "loo" on the downbeat

Respond to the gesture; do not guess how long the pause will last.

1. Show a silent preparation gesture and let the group breathe naturally with it; avoid breath holding.
2. Add a comfortable 'loo' on the next downbeat for two beats.
3. Vary the pause before preparation so singers respond to the gesture instead of guessing the timing.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Entrances occur together after the preparation, without a premature gasp.

COMMON TRAP

Holding the breath after the preparation.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a larger gesture and spoken count before removing the count.